Doug Vargas

Head of Product · Senior Product Designer (UX/UI) · Design Engineer

Barranquilla, Colombia
hello@douguizard.com – +57 300 351 8299
douguizard.com – linkedin.com/in/dougvargasco – behance.net/dougvargas

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November 2026

Hello,

I'm a product designer who also writes code. In practice, that means I rarely hand off a spec and wait to see what comes back. I build a working version, put it in front of the people who will use it, and stay with it after it ships.

My most recent role was Head of Product at Naowee, where we digitized how Colombia's sports system is inspected and regulated: about 1,200 organizations and 30 procedures that used to live in Word files and email. Before drawing a single screen, I mapped more than 45 states and 15 roles. Then I built the flows as prototypes and walked through them, story by story, with the analysts who have to sign off. Disagreements came up early, while they were still cheap to fix.

Before Naowee, I worked on Andes, Mercado Libre's design system, used by more than 400 designers and 2,000 engineers across 18 countries. At that scale, a small change to one component can break dozens of screens you will never see. It taught me to care about the details other people build on, and to only write rules that can actually be enforced in code.

I use AI every day, and I check its work. On olbo, a budgeting app I designed and built, I rebuilt the whole interface with AI help and didn't touch the budget math: all 647 tests had to stay green before anything shipped.

If your team needs someone who can take an idea from a rough sketch to something real people can use, I'd love to talk.

Best regards,

Doug Vargas